
CHURN IS DEAD

The Scope Line Audit

A one-quarter favor-load diagnostic for CS teams

This playbook turns the invisible favor load into a number your org can see. Score your team honestly against each component of The Scope Line, then run the one-quarter audit to expose what you're spending senior human judgment on for free.

Scoring: Rate each item 1-5. 1 = not happening, 5 = embedded in operations.

Created by: Kuber Sethi

Source: churnisdead.com

Version: 1.0 -- August 2026

SECTION 1

1. In-Contract: Name What the Renewal Pays For

Every favor is born in ambiguity. When nobody has stated the edge of the contract, everything feels included, and the CSM absorbs the difference.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
CSM can articulate entitlements in one sentence	Every CSM can state the specific entitlements, response commitments, and review count for each account without checking	CSMs guess, hedge, or default to 'whatever the customer needs' when asked what the contract covers
Customer knows the edge too	Scope is said out loud in kickoff; both sides can point at the same edge	Customer assumes everything is included because it was never stated
Onboarding scope is concretely defined	'Onboarding' has a written definition of what it covers and where it stops	Onboarding is open-ended and stretches until the CSM decides to stop
Entitlements are documented and accessible	A one-pager exists per tier; CSMs and customers reference it	Entitlements live only in the master contract nobody reads

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
CSMs can state contract entitlements in one sentence, unprompted	1-5
Scope edge is communicated explicitly to the customer at kickoff	1-5
What 'onboarding' and 'support' concretely include is written down	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 2

2. The Favor Ledger: Count for One Quarter

You cannot manage what you have never once counted. The favor load never touches the CRM, the capacity model, or cost-to-serve — it shows up as burnout and resignations.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Out-of-contract requests are logged	Every request that falls outside the contract is captured in a shared ledger the moment it lands	Favors live in someone's Apple Notes, or nowhere at all
Hours per favor are estimated	Each logged favor has an estimated time cost attached	No one knows what a single favor cost; effort is invisible
Totals are rolled up per account	Hours are summed per account, exposing which accounts consume the most free judgment	Favor load is spread across CSMs and never aggregated
The count runs for a full quarter	A complete quarter of data exists before any conclusions are drawn	Counting is anecdotal, one-off, or abandoned after a week
Findings are reviewed with leadership	The totaled ledger is presented to management as the basis for change	Data is collected but never surfaced, so nothing changes

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
A shared favor ledger exists and is actively used	1-5
Each favor has an estimated hours cost recorded	1-5
Favor hours are totaled per account and reviewed by leadership	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 3

3. Route, Don't Absorb: Tag and Redirect Every Favor

The real problem isn't that CSMs love scope creep — it's that the only available action is to absorb it. There is no 'route this' button. Every favor must go somewhere deliberate.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Each favor is tagged by type	Every request is tagged: product gap / priced-services candidate / relationship investment / should-be-a-no	Everything is lumped together as 'the relationship'
Product gaps route to product	Product-gap favors become logged bug reports and feature requests product can see and fund	CSMs silently paper over product holes; product never learns the cost
Services work routes to a priced SKU	Custom dashboards, training, and integration builds go to a billable services motion	Billable work is given away for free, competing against the company's own price list
A documented 'no' is a real option	There is a legitimate, supported path to a polite, documented no	Saying no feels like abandoning the customer, so yes is the only answer
A routing mechanism actually exists	There is a defined action and owner for each tag — a real change-order equivalent	The only mechanism is the CSM's own time; there is nowhere to send a request

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Every out-of-contract request is tagged by type	1-5
Product gaps and services work are routed to their owners, not absorbed	1-5
A documented 'no' is a legitimate, supported outcome	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 4

4. The Relationship Line: Keep the Deliberate Few

The point of counting was never to eliminate generosity — it's to distinguish real relationship investment from unpriced professional services. Keep the small set of unpriced moves that build the coalition an agent can't.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Relationship investments are deliberate	The unpriced moves kept are a small, chosen set with a clear coalition-building rationale	Every favor is rationalized as 'relationship' after the fact
Relationship moves build a coalition	Kept favors deepen champions and multi-threading a machine could never replicate	Free work creates dependency that looks exactly like something automatable
The set stays genuinely small	A minority of requests survive as true relationship investment; the rest are routed	Most favors are absorbed under the relationship banner
Value is not trained to feel free	Customers understand what is a gift versus what is included or billable	Accounts are trained across CSMs to believe everything is free and nothing has a price

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
The unpriced moves kept are deliberate and coalition-focused	1-5
Genuine relationship investment is a small minority of total favors	1-5
Customers understand the difference between a gift and an entitlement	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

CHURN IS DEAD

Your Scorecard

Dimension	Your Score	Max
1. 1. In-Contract: Name What the Renewal Pays For	_____	5
2. 2. The Favor Ledger: Count for One Quarter	_____	5
3. 3. Route, Don't Absorb: Tag and Redirect Every Favor	_____	5
4. 4. The Relationship Line: Keep the Deliberate Few	_____	5
TOTAL	_____	20

Total Score	Assessment	What It Means
16-20	Uncuttable	Embedded, measurable, strategically irreplaceable.
12-15	Defensible	Solid but gaps remain. Focus on lowest dimension.
8-11	Vulnerable	Real risk ahead. Treat as urgent.
4-7	Critical	Cannot survive scrutiny. Major changes needed.

What to do next: Take your lowest-scoring section and build a 30-day action plan. One at a time. Then share this with leadership -- not to ask permission, but to show you know where the gaps are.

The point of counting was never to eliminate generosity. It was to find out how much of it was actually generosity.

-- Kuber

churnisdead.com | Weekly frameworks that replace hope with strategy.